

ISHTIAQ AKANDA

New York, NY

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TECHNOLOGIES

Operating Systems - Linux (Ubuntu), macOS

Systems & Remote Access - SSH, VMware (UB HPC labs), Xpra, VPN configuration

Scripting & Automation Bash - Python, data pipelines, REST API integrations

Languages - Python, JavaScript, SQL, PHP, Scala, HTML5, CSS3

Frameworks & Tools - ReactJS, Node.js, Express.js, Chart.js

Infrastructure - Git, GitHub, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Docker (learning), CI/CD concepts

Cloud - AWS (Solutions Architect certification in progress)

SOFTWARE PROJECTS

US Economic Dashboard [Github](#) | [Deployment](#)

Feb - Mar 2026

An economic dashboard that implements data from the FRED (Federal Reserve) API

- Engineered a full-stack macroeconomic dashboard integrating the FRED API, built a custom Express backend to normalize complex government data structures and deliver clean JSON to a React frontend.
- Deployed and maintained the application in a Linux environment, managing process lifecycle, environment variables, and production logging, practices directly transferable to fleet operations.
- Implemented interactive Chart.js visualizations enabling real-time trend analysis across economic indicators.

Mahjong Game - [Github](#) | [Figma](#) | [Development](#)

Feb - May 2025

An interactive American Mahjong game.

- Led full-stack implementation supporting 100+ concurrent users, resolved real-time state synchronization challenges by integrating persistent database triggers to eliminate race conditions.
- Deployed to University at Buffalo Linux servers via SSH terminal and WinSCP file transfer, using Cisco AnyConnect VPN to establish secure remote access to the university network.
- Managed the PHP backend, including schema design, query optimization, and data integrity enforcement across concurrent sessions.
- Coordinated a cross-functional team using Git, enforcing branching conventions and conducting code reviews.

EDUCATION

Software Engineering Fellowship - The Marcy Lab School

Brooklyn, NY | Sep 2025 - Present

Completing 2,000+ hours of intensive training in CS fundamentals, full-stack development, and engineering best practices, including Linux command-line tooling, Git workflows, and automated testing.

Candidate For Computer Science BA (100+ Credits) - University at Buffalo

Buffalo, NY | Aug 2021

Coursework: Data Structures, Algorithms, Software Engineering, Microeconomic & Macroeconomic Theory, Economic Statistics.

Systems exposure: Used VMware virtualized Linux environments and Xpra remote desktop for coursework and lab access; managed SSH sessions and transferred files via WinSCP to university servers using Cisco AnyConnect VPN for secure remote connectivity.

EXPERIENCE

Data Operations Intern - Safe Medical Care

Bronx, NY | Dec 2020 - Feb 2021

- Processed and validated 500+ patient records into a clinical EHR portal, enforcing data integrity standards that reduced processing errors and cut record retrieval time by 30%.
- Wrote Python scripts to automate data validation and flag inconsistencies, reducing manual review time across a 3-person operations team.
- Analyzed patient intake workflows to identify scheduling bottlenecks, improving appointment throughput by 20%.

CERTIFICATIONS

IBM: [Data Fundamentals](#) & [Getting Started With Data](#) | Coursera: [Interactivity with JavaScript](#), [Introduction to Structured Query Language \(SQL\)](#) & AWS Solutions Architect Associate — in progress